

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

HOUSE CONCURRENT
RESOLUTION 1024

By: Hildebrant of the House

and

Seifried of the Senate

AS INTRODUCED

A Resolution designating April 21 as Route 66 Day;
recognizing individual's contribution to Route 66 in
Oklahoma; recognizing the cultural and economic
impact of Route 66 in Oklahoma; and providing for
distribution.

WHEREAS, the Bureau of Public Roads, the predecessor to the U.S.
Department of Transportation, officially approved the national
highway system on November 11, 1926, making 2026 the one hundredth
anniversary of Route 66; and

WHEREAS, Cyrus Stevens Avery from Tulsa, Oklahoma, was appointed
chairman of the Oklahoma Highway Commission in 1924 and through this
role he was instrumental in determining the path of Route 66 from
Chicago to Los Angeles; and

WHEREAS, Cyrus Avery and B.P. Piepmeier sent a telegram to the
Bureau of Public Roads in Washington, D.C., on April 30, 1926,

1 accepting the designation of the route from Chicago to Los Angeles
2 as Highway 66; and

3 WHEREAS, Cherokee citizen, Andy Payne, from Foyil, Oklahoma, won
4 the "Bunion Derby" in 1928, a 3,423-mile transcontinental race from
5 Los Angeles to New York in 573 hours, 4 minutes, and 34 seconds,
6 conceived by sports promoter Charles Pyle to promote Route 66; and

7 WHEREAS, in 1935, the U.S. Highway 66 Association designated
8 Route 66 as the "Will Rogers Highway" in honor of Will Rogers,
9 Oklahoma's favorite son; and

10 WHEREAS, Oklahoma has over 400 drivable miles of Route 66 today,
11 more than any other state; and

12 WHEREAS, Oklahoma counties with a section of Route 66 realize
13 more than 12 million annual visitors with more than \$1 billion in
14 direct earnings due to travel and support more than 46,000 jobs
15 directly related to travel and tourism; and

16 WHEREAS, in 2023, the Oklahoma Legislature created the Oklahoma
17 Route 66 Commission to provide grants for historic preservation and
18 economic development in communities along the road and over \$21
19 million has been awarded to date; and

20 WHEREAS, the Oklahoma Route 66 Centennial Commission has planned
21 special events throughout 2026 including the largest centennial
22 celebration in the nation on May 30.

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1 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
2 OF THE 2ND SESSION OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE, THE SENATE
3 CONCURRING THEREIN:

4 THAT the Oklahoma House and Senate recognize April 21, 2026, as
5 Route 66 Day at the Capitol.

6 THAT the Oklahoma House and Senate celebrate the one hundredth
7 anniversary of Route 66 and the many Oklahomans throughout the years
8 who have contributed to its success.

9 THAT the Oklahoma House and Senate offer sincere thanks to the
10 Oklahoma Route 66 Centennial Commission and the Oklahoma Route 66
11 Commission and their partner agencies.

12 THAT copies of this resolution be distributed to Lt. Governor
13 Matt Pinnell, chairman of the Oklahoma Route 66 Centennial
14 Commission, and Thomas Tillison, chairman of the Oklahoma Route 66
15 Commission.

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